

he had always stood against. When fighting broke out, he was the only U.S. senator from a Southern state to remain loyal to the Union.

As a War Democrat—having split from those among the Democratic Party who opposed the war—Johnson attracted the attention of Republican strategists seeking a vice-presidential candidate for the 1864 election. The party needed to reach out to Democrats willing to back the war effort. Their choice of Johnson as Lincoln's running mate, both on a National Union ticket, served to show that the Union represented something more than just the Republicans under another name.